



Uncle Ben Spiderman

Marvel Comics' Spider-geddon event will feature Uncle Ben and Osborn turning into Spider-Heroes. <https://digit.in/Aug18-56-1>



MIB4 begins filming

Sony Pictures has started filming the sequel to Men In Black and photos of Chris Hemsworth have come out. <https://digit.in/Aug18-56-2>

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henever the topic of comic books in India comes up, it mostly refers to the 'golden-age' classics like

Chacha Chaudhary, Amar Chitra Katha and Raj Comics in their heydays. When it doesn't, it is used to refer to international titles from houses like Marvel and DC available in India. What most of us, repeatedly, miss out on are the amazing titles and comic books being made right here, in our country, by an insanely talented lot of artists and publishers. These titles cover all kinds of stories, ranging from retelling our mythology to all-new,

One such major publisher in India right now is Holy Cow Entertainment. Multiple serialised titles like Aghori, Caster, Showcase and more form their portfolio. They specialise in retelling Indian mythology in various ways and now they've even created a connected universe among their characters. Mumbai-based Vivek Goel, the founder of HCE, was formerly employed by Raj Comics as an Inker. He broke into the new comic book scene with Ravanayan back in 2011 and since then, Holy Cow Entertainment has made a name for itself in the mythological comics sub genre.

Studio Kokaachi is another name that is doing something very different. Their focus is far away from stories of

need to be about superheroes, magic and fantasy or something that has a distinct commercial selling point. At Studio Kokaachi, we've been creating content for a grown up audience for more than 7 years now. As the number of art design colleges grows in India, nowadays we are getting student-turned-artists who are on top of niche techniques and alternative methods of storytelling."

Another interesting phenomenon that is contributing to the growing demand for mature comic books is the availability of mature video content. In India, the availability of high speed, accessible internet coincided with the growing popularity of video streaming platforms like Netflix, Prime Video

India's comic book dream

The comic book scene in India is about to explode – if you can light the fuse

indigenous superheroes and more. We reached out to some of the most promising names in the Indian comic book industry right now and tried to understand what the contemporary Indian comic book scene is all about.

CREATION

There's no shortage of creators in India – and the comic book scene is no different. However, due to the prevailing image of comic books being meant for children, especially in our country, there hasn't been a tendency to choose comic books as a means to tell meaningful stories. But that scene is changing now. Creators are working on developing something completely different and niche, the comic book scene in India is on the verge of a massive breakthrough.

superheroes and mythological retellings - they focus on real life. Studio Kokaachi's work isn't dependent on a particular artist. It's managed by Pratheek and Tina, who come from a background in comics through Manta Ray, another comic book studio that shut shop in recent times. In fact, they've continued Manta Ray's Mixtape series on in Kokaachi. They even have some completely free to read titles under the mantle of Zero-Calorie Comics that you can download from their website. While their website might seem to be the primary way to get Studio Kokaachi's titles, they're also available in about 40 stores across India.

"The main problem right now is to educate the audience" says Tina, "We, as an audience, need to overcome the perception that comic books either

and multiple homegrown platforms. Whereas content was primarily family oriented before this, suddenly everyone had a device and individuals could be targeted. This led to the growing demand for more mature, dark and gritty stories from such platforms which has now primed the Indian audience for similar stories told through the medium of comic books.

DISTRIBUTION

One of the major issues that the comic book scene faces right now is distribution. While legacy comic book publishers like Amar Chitra Katha and Raj Comics have an established network of distributors, up and coming names find it difficult to find exposure at the same scale. "Most of the titles that are changing the comic book scene